

1 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 20 minutes

Map an imaginary island

What we are practising

Represent an imagined place using pictures and simple symbols.

What you need

Paper / Pencils or crayons

Describe the island while an adult draws.

Before you begin

Draw a large outline with room for three places.

An adult explains as needed and uses intact, age-appropriate drawing materials.

Try it together

1. Add a home, a pond and a surprising place such as a singing tree.
2. Connect the places with paths and choose a symbol for each.
3. Trace a journey while telling what happens at each stop.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What symbol would help a visitor find your special place?

Space to explore

2 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 30 minutes

A recycled toy shelter

What we are practising

Plan, make and revise a structure for a stated purpose.

What you need

Clean small cardboard box / Scrap cardboard / Paper tape / Small soft toy / Paper / Pencil

Use folded paper walls without tape.

Before you begin

An adult removes staples and rough edges and cuts any needed doorway.

An adult handles all cutting and checks packaging for staples; no plastic bags, strings or sharp scraps.

Try it together

1. Place the toy beside the box and sketch a shelter with an entrance.
2. Build walls or a roof using cardboard and tape.
3. Test whether the toy fits and the entrance works; change one part if needed.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How will the toy enter without knocking the roof off?

Space to explore

3 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 20 minutes

Over-and-under paper weaving

What we are practising

Follow an alternating action to create a woven pattern.

What you need

Two paper colours / Scissors for adult use / Paper tape

Lay strips over a drawn grid without weaving.

Before you begin

An adult prepares four broad parallel strips taped at one end and four loose strips.

An adult cuts all broad strips; the child weaves away from the scissors.

Try it together

1. Slide one loose strip over the first fixed strip, under the second, over the third and under the fourth.
2. Weave the next strip in the opposite order.
3. Repeat with remaining strips and gently slide the rows together.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What changes at the start of the second row?

Space to explore

4 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 15 minutes

Draw a tiny music score

What we are practising

Use a shared symbol system to communicate a creative sequence.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Use silent hand movements instead of sounds.

Before you begin

Agree circle means clap, line means knee tap and empty box means silence.

Keep sounds gentle and movements comfortable; avoid any sound that feels unpleasant.

Try it together

1. Draw four equal boxes and put a symbol in each, leaving one empty.
2. Point steadily to each box while performing its sound or pause.
3. Exchange the score with a partner, then change one symbol and compare.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How can we show a pause without a word?

Space to explore

5 / 5 | Ages 5-6 | 20 minutes

One subject, three styles

What we are practising

Explore how different visual choices change an image.

What you need

Paper / Crayons or pencils

Describe three imagined versions while an adult sketches.

Before you begin

Divide a page into three spaces and choose a tree as the starter subject.

An adult explains as needed and uses intact, age-appropriate drawing materials.

Try it together

1. Draw a tree in the first space using mostly straight lines.
2. Draw it again using mostly curves, then a third time using dots.
3. Give each version a title and describe which marks changed its mood.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which version feels calm or lively to you, and why?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Map an imaginary island

A little hint

Use a simple repeated mark, such as a music note for the singing tree.

Answer / what to notice

Any connected, explainable map works; invented geography is welcome.

A map uses selected symbols to represent places without drawing every detail.

Make it easier

Draw two places and one path.

Take it further

Add a small key explaining three symbols.

Another day, away from the screen

Let another person choose a route and tell the adventure.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. A recycled toy shelter

A little hint

Compare the entrance with the toy's widest part.

Answer / what to notice

A shelter succeeds if the toy fits and can enter; appearance can vary.

Testing against a purpose helps us decide what to improve.

Make it easier

Use an open-sided box and add a roof only.

Take it further

Add a second room with a connecting entrance.

Another day, away from the screen

Invent a visitor and a story set in the shelter.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Over-and-under paper weaving

A little hint

If the first row starts over, the next starts under.

Answer / what to notice

Adjacent rows alternate their starting position to interlock the strips.

Passing strips above and below each other holds a woven arrangement together.

Make it easier

Use two fixed strips and one loose strip.

Take it further

Choose colours to create an additional repeating pattern.

Another day, away from the screen

Look closely at the woven threads of a towel.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Draw a tiny music score

A little hint

Keep an empty box the same length as a sounding box.

Answer / what to notice

Any sequence that follows the agreed key works; an empty box represents one beat of silence.

Symbols let another person recreate our chosen pattern.

Make it easier

Use two boxes and one sound type.

Take it further

Compose eight boxes with two planned pauses.

Another day, away from the screen

Make a gentle soundtrack for a four-part story.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. One subject, three styles

A little hint

There is no required mood; point to a mark that supports your idea.

Answer / what to notice

All three interpretations are valid; the discussion should connect choices with effects.

Changing marks can alter a picture while keeping its subject recognisable.

Make it easier

Try only two styles.

Take it further

Repeat using different sizes or colours and compare.

Another day, away from the screen

Display the three versions as a small family exhibition.